

ScholarAid: An AI-Powered Scholarship Website Enhancing Access Application Preparedness among Senior High School Students in the Philippines

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Background of the Study

Many students face significant challenges in accessing scholarship opportunities due to limited awareness and information barriers. According to studies made by Scott-Clayton (2022), students often lack sufficient knowledge about available financial aid programs, which reduces their chances of applying.

Additionally, financial difficulties further limit the students' ability to apply, as some prioritize immediate needs or work over scholarship applications, which also affects their academic performance (Zabala & Gutierrez, 2017; Aban et al., 2025).

Even if they are aware, the application process is still often complicated and unclear. While existing digital systems help improve access, most are administrative-focused and lack personalized support for students (Sakhare et al., 2024; Amer, 2025).

Because of these challenges, there is a need for a more accessible and centralized system for scholarships.

Problem Statement

The study aims to develop an AI-powered scholarship website that enhances access to scholarship information and improves application preparedness among Senior High School students in the Philippines.

The researchers specifically sought answers to the following:

1. What challenges do Senior High School students face in accessing scholarship opportunities in terms of:
 - a. Accessibility
 - b. Financial difficulties
 - c. Lack of Awareness
2. How effective are existing digital platforms in helping students find and apply for scholarships?
3. How can an AI-powered scholarship website improve students' access to scholarship information and application preparedness?
4. How do users evaluate the developed system in terms of usability, accessibility, and usefulness?

Research Objectives

This study aims to develop an AI-powered scholarship website that enhances access to scholarship information and improves application preparedness among Senior High School students in the Philippines.

Specifically, this study aims:

1. To identify the challenges faced by Senior High School students in accessing scholarship opportunities in terms of accessibility, financial difficulties, and lack of awareness.
2. To assess the effectiveness of existing digital platforms in helping students find and apply for scholarships.
3. To develop an AI-powered scholarship website that provides personalized recommendations and improves access to scholarship information.
4. To evaluate the developed system in terms of usability, accessibility, and usefulness.

Significance of the Study

The results of the study will be beneficial to the following:

Students. This study will help them easily find suitable scholarships and improve their application preparedness through personalized recommendations.

Schools. This study will provide a tool that can support guidance offices in assisting students with scholarship opportunities.

Government and Scholarship Providers. This study will improve dissemination of scholarship information and helps reach more qualified applicants efficiently, promoting their programs.

Future Researchers. This study will serve as a reference for studies related to AI-based systems, scholarship access, and student support technologies.

Scope and Delimitation

This study focuses on the development and evaluation of ScholarAid, an AI-powered scholarship website designed to improve scholarship accessibility and application preparedness among students. It specifically involves Grade 12 Senior High School students from Polytechnic University of the Philippines - Sta. Mesa as respondents, who are considered prospective college students seeking for financial assistance.

The study is further limited to examining scholarship accessibility and application preparedness and does not cover long-term outcomes such as academic performance or retention of scholars. Additionally, the system is limited to local scholarship programs and does not include international opportunities. The study also excludes the collection of sensitive personal information such as their age, phone numbers, addresses, and other private data, as the system only requires necessary and non-sensitive inputs.

Review of Related Literature

Scholarship Accessibility

Diva, J. D. D., Acal, E. J. S., & Milallos Jr., E. R. (2026). Students' Awareness and Satisfaction with Financial Aid and Scholarship Services: A Descriptive Institutional Study in San Isidro College. School of Education Research Journal, 27990230. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18886103>

Bisenio, J. E., & Doloso Jr., Dr. E. D. (2026). Governance, Accessibility, and Academic Impact of a Local Government Educational Subsidy Program: A Case Study of College Beneficiaries in Baao, Camarines Sur. International Journal of Research Publications, 187(1), 169–174. <https://doi.org/10.47119/IJRP10018711220258545>

Review of Related Literature

Financial Difficulties

Aban, J. L., Sevilaja, A. N., Asiro, J. A., Ebueza, R. D., Calica, S. E., & Navasca, M. G. (2025). Students' financial, environmental, mental, and physical challenges and their predictors: A public higher education case in the Philippines. *The International Journal of Interdisciplinary Educational Studies*, 20(2), 193–223. <https://doi.org/10.18848/2327-011X/CGP/v20i02/193-223>

Zabala, B. A., & Gutierrez, M. P. (2017). Economically deprived and marginalized scholars: their lifestyles, experiences, challenges and aspirations. *OALib*, 04(02), 1–14. <https://doi.org/10.4236/oalib.1103395>

Review of Related Literature

Lack of Awareness

Diva, J. D. D., Acal, E. J. S., & Milallos Jr., E. R. (2026). Students' Awareness and Satisfaction with Financial Aid and Scholarship Services: A Descriptive Institutional Study in San Isidro College. School of Education Research Journal, 27990230. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.18886103>

Khatri, Dr. V., Gidwani, K., Atrey, Y., Gupta, R., & Dua, H. (2023). Research on the Awareness of Various Scholarships and Courses Available in India and Development of an Online Courses and Scholarships Portal. International Research Journal of Modernization in Engineering Technology and Science, 5(1), 25825208. <https://doi.org/10.56726/irjmet33002>

Review of Related Literature

Technology for Scholarship

Sakhare, D., Jadhav, P., Sakat, S., Amrit, S., & Shelke, G. (2024). Enhancing Student Access to Financial Aid: A Web-Based Approach to Scholarship Search and Application. *International Journal of Innovate Science and Research Technology*, 9(10), 1402–1408. <https://doi.org/10.38124/ijisrt/IJISRT24OCT1180>

Samillano, S. G., Rabino, M., Arias, J. M., Palmones, L., Cagatan, M., Jimenez Jr., A., & Del Rosario, J. (2025). Development of LYDO Scholarship Management System. *International Journal of Engineering Research & Technology*, 14(12), 22780181. <https://www.ijert.org/research/development-of-lydo-scholarship-management-system-IJERTV14IS120406.pdf>

Research Gap

Existing studies confirm that scholarships are available and beneficial, but significant challenges remain:

- Students often face low awareness, fragmented information, and complex application procedures, limiting their ability to apply.
- Current digital systems tend to be administrative-focused and lack student-centered features such as personalized guidance and centralized access to scholarship opportunities.
- There is a limited number of localized studies in the Philippine context, especially on Grade 12 Senior High School students, who are at a critical stage of preparing for higher education.

These gaps indicate the need for a centralized and intelligent system to simplify scholarship access and provide support throughout the application process.

Proposed Solution

Researchers proposes the development of an AI-powered scholarship website designed to improve the accessibility and application preparedness among Grade 12 Senior High School Students. The system, called ScholarAid, aims to address common challenges such as lack of awareness, scattered information, and difficulty in understanding scholarship requirements and processes.

The system will ask relevant, non-sensitive questions such as their academic strand, interests, and qualification. From the inputs, the system will provide clear and organized information about scholarship requirements, deadlines, and application processes to help students better prepare.

The researchers aims to make the application process more accessible, efficient, and user-friendly. Above all, ScholarAid seeks to empower students to make informed decisions and increase their chances of successfully applying for scholarships.



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